Yiheng Ji

jyh216@utexas.edu | Website | Google Scholar | GitHub | LinkedIn

Education

The University of Texas at Austin — Austin, TX
Ph.D. in Mechanical Engineering — Aug. 2024 – Present
Advisor: Luis Sentis. Research interests: robot learning, decision-making under uncertainty, and safe autonomy.

University of California, Berkeley — Berkeley, CA
B.S. in Mechanical Engineering — Aug. 2020 – May 2024
Research advisors: Francesco Borrelli and Mark W. Mueller.

Publications

Catch Me If You Can: Real-Time Feedback Denoising for Responsive VLAs
Yiheng Ji, Xingru Zhou, Luis Sentis, Mingyo Seo
Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL), 2026. Paper | Website | Code

Occlusion-Aware Safe Overtaking under Early Deployment of Connected Vehicles
Haoji Liu*, **Yiheng Ji***, Yu Chul Lee, Yiming Yan, Ji Hwan Park, Junmin Wang
American Control Conference (ACC), 2025. Paper

Experience

Human Centered Robotics Laboratory, UT Austin, Graduate Researcher — Aug. 2024 – Present

Roboligent, Inc., Research Intern — Sep. 2025 – Apr. 2026

HiPeRLab, UC Berkeley, Research Assistant — Jan. 2023 – May 2024

MPC Lab, UC Berkeley, Research Assistant — May 2023 – May 2024

Projects

Advanced Robotic Physical Therapy System
Alexander Ambrose, **Yiheng Ji**, Luis Sentis
Technical report, Human Centered Robotics Laboratory, UT Austin, April 2026.

Academic Service

Reviewer, IEEE Robotics and Automation Letters (RA-L) — 2026

Skills

Python • PyTorch • ROS 2 • Pinocchio • OpenCV • Vision-Language-Action Models • Diffusion Models • iLQR • Inverse Kinematics